PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst/Lead | Detection Engineering, Threat and Vulnerability Management, Sentinel and Defender XDR

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience leading detection engineering, threat and vulnerability management (TVM), and Security Operations Centre (SOC) operations in complex enterprise environments. I have deep hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), and Kusto Query Language (KQL), which I use daily to build, tune and validate detection content, investigate incidents and drive continuous improvement in security posture. At the University of the Arts London, I oversee a threat detection programme covering 8,000 users, managing the full lifecycle from alert engineering through incident response under the NIST 800-61 framework. I bring a methodical, evidence-led approach to threat and vulnerability management, using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to maintain an up-to-date picture of risk and drive remediation through risk-based prioritisation. I am ready to step into a Senior Analyst or Lead role and contribute immediately to a high-performing security operations function.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL analytics rules, detection-as-code, MITRE ATT&CK mapping), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, alert tuning, false-positive reduction, security content lifecycle management
- **XDR and EDR Platforms:** Microsoft Defender XDR (Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for Office 365), CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover
- **Threat and Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera BAS, risk-prioritised remediation, patch management oversight, attack surface monitoring
- **Incident Response and Threat Hunting:** NIST 800-61 framework, MITRE ATT&CK adversary emulation, threat hunting with KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, digital forensics triage, root cause analysis
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps playbooks, PowerShell scripting, automated triage and containment workflows
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Email Security:** Mimecast, Microsoft Defender for Office 365, anti-phishing, DKIM/DMARC/SPF enforcement
- **Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune MDM and Mobile Application Management (MAM), CrowdStrike Falcon, Tanium
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead detection engineering across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, owning the full detection content lifecycle: rule design, testing, deployment and ongoing tuning against an 8,000-user threat surface
- Conduct advanced threat hunting using Microsoft Defender XDR, Sentinel KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying adversarial activity not surfaced by automated alerts
- Manage the threat and vulnerability management programme, operating Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentera BAS to maintain continuous asset risk visibility and drive risk-based remediation prioritisation
- Lead incident response investigations using the NIST 800-61 lifecycle, coordinating containment, eradication and recovery across endpoint, identity, network and cloud domains
- Oversee Microsoft Defender XDR operations, correlating signals across MDE, MDI and Defender for Office 365, and managing escalation workflows for high-severity incidents

- Engineer SOAR automation in Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps playbooks, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for Tier 1 and Tier 2 alerts through automated triage and containment
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM, governing privileged account access, session monitoring and least-privilege enforcement across the enterprise
- Develop and present threat and vulnerability management reports to senior leadership, translating technical risk into business impact and prioritised remediation roadmaps
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID identity controls including Conditional Access, MFA and SSO, reducing identity-based attack surface across all accounts
- Oversee Mimecast email security gateway and Microsoft Defender for Office 365, enforcing DKIM, DMARC and anti-phishing controls

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Performed daily alert triage and investigation in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, escalating confirmed incidents and maintaining incident records in the ticketing system
- Supported development and tuning of Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules, contributing to measurable reductions in false-positive volumes and improved detection fidelity
- Operated the vulnerability management programme using Nessus and AppCheck, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports and tracking remediation progress
- Conducted threat hunting exercises in CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Defender XDR, identifying credential-access and lateral movement attempts
- Assisted in Defender for Endpoint rollout to 8,000 endpoints, managing onboarding, policy compliance and alert workflow configuration
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM onboarding, configuring session policies, vault entries and audit trails for privileged accounts
- Participated in MITRE ATT&CK-based tabletop exercises and contributed to detection gap analysis and improvement planning

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Implemented Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Azure Active Directory (now Entra ID) with MFA and Conditional Access for a cloud-first SaaS platform
- Performed infrastructure vulnerability assessments and tracked remediation to CIS Controls and ISO 27001 standards
- Supported SOC 2 Type II audit preparation by documenting security controls and providing evidence for access management, logging and monitoring
- Automated security hygiene tasks using PowerShell, reducing manual effort for patching, compliance reporting and account management

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built 40+ custom Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, achieving measurable coverage improvements across initial access, privilege escalation, lateral movement and exfiltration
- Directed UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus recertification, coordinating remediation evidence across SIEM, EDR, identity and endpoint management workstreams
- Designed and deployed SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel automating phishing triage and account lockdown, saving approximately 8 hours of analyst time per week
- Managed threat and vulnerability management programme across 8,000-user estate, achieving consistent remediation of critical vulnerabilities within defined SLA windows using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS
- Conducted proactive threat hunt identifying a dormant credential-access campaign across 15 endpoints, enabling full containment before lateral movement escalated
- Led CrowdStrike Falcon EDR deployment at UAL, reducing mean time to contain (MTTC) for endpoint threats by over 60% through improved prevention policy tuning

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)